

SAGI RAMA KRISHNAM RAJU ENGINEERING COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)

(Approved by AICTE, New Delhi, Affiliated to JNTUK, Kakinada)

Accredited by NAAC with A+ Grade, Accredited by NBA (UG: Civil, CSE, ECE, EEE, IT & ME)

Recognised as Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation

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INNOVATION AND INCUBATION POLICY

2026

1. Preamble

Sagi Rama Krishnam Raju Engineering College (SRKREC) is committed to fostering a culture of innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, and technology-driven problem solving among students, faculty, researchers, alumni, and the wider community. Recognizing the importance of innovation and startup ecosystems in driving economic growth, employment generation, and societal transformation, the institution has established a comprehensive framework to support ideation, incubation, intellectual property creation, technology commercialization, and startup development.

In alignment with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, the AICTE National Innovation and Startup Policy (NISP), the initiatives of the Ministry of Education's Innovation Cell (MIC), Startup India, and the Government of Andhra Pradesh's innovation and entrepreneurship initiatives, SRKREC seeks to create an enabling environment that encourages entrepreneurial thinking and innovation-led development. The Institution's Innovation Council (IIC), functioning under the Entrepreneurship Development Cell (E-Cell), serves as a catalyst for promoting innovation, startup awareness, design thinking, and entrepreneurship across all disciplines.

This Innovation and Incubation Policy provide a structured framework for supporting faculty, students, researchers, alumni, and aspiring entrepreneurs in transforming innovative ideas into sustainable products, services, and enterprises. The policy outlines the mechanisms for incubation support, intellectual property management, startup creation, seed funding, technology transfer, industry collaboration, conflict resolution, and commercialization of innovations. Through this policy, SRKREC aims to strengthen its innovation ecosystem and contribute to the development of successful startups that create economic, social, and environmental impact at regional, national, and global levels.

2. Objectives

The Innovation and Incubation ecosystem at SRKREC is built upon the following key objectives:

1. Promotion of innovation, creativity, design thinking, and entrepreneurial culture.
2. Strengthening Institution's Innovation Council (IIC) activities under the Entrepreneurship Development Cell (E-Cell).
3. Supporting ideation, prototype development, startup creation, and business incubation.
4. Facilitating industry-academia collaboration, mentoring, and market linkages.
5. Promoting intellectual property creation, patent filing, and technology transfer.
6. Organizing hackathons, innovation contests, startup awareness programs, and entrepreneurship development activities.
7. Mobilizing resources through government schemes, industry partnerships, and funding agencies.
8. Encouraging interdisciplinary collaboration for solving societal and industrial challenges.
9. Supporting student-led and faculty-led startups with incubation and business development

assistance.

10. Creating a sustainable innovation ecosystem that contributes to economic growth, social impact, and national development.

The policy is subjected to periodical review and amendments. It will be the responsibility of the companies admitted to E-Cell at SRKREC to update themselves from time to time on the amendments in Innovation and Incubation policy and procedures. E-Cell, SRKREC reserves the rights to make an exception of all or any of the terms of policy for a particular company or a promoter on a case-to-case basis.

3. Thrust Areas

E-Cell, SRKREC will support students and innovators who are having an idea with high impact and which has very good opportunity to be a successful startup. Any Individual / group of people (students or general public or mix of the two) can initially propose an idea with prime features as mentioned below:

- (a) Innovativeness
- (b) Commercial viability
- (c) Technical feasibility
- (d) Social sensibility
- (e) Scalability

E-Cell accepts innovative ideas and startup proposals from diverse domains, including but not limited to the following:

- Precision Aquaculture and Agriculture
- Smart Manufacturing
- Unmanned Aerial Vehicle
- Waste Management
- Internet of Things
- Artificial Intelligence
- Cyber Security and Data Science
- Hybrid Electric Vehicles
- Sensors and Embedded Systems
- Advanced Materials
- Robotics and Automation
- EdTech and Learning Technologies
- E-Commerce and Digital Marketing

4. Infrastructure of E-Cell, SRKREC

Upon admission to E-Cell, SRKREC, the following facilities will be offered to the incubatees on

an individual basis:

1. Office space
2. Computers up to two on rental basis.
3. Internet connection
4. Standard furniture as decided by E-Cell, SRKREC.

E-Cell provides a common pool of hard and soft infrastructure to be shared by all incubatees. The following resources are provided:

1. Printer
2. LCD Projector
3. Document Scanner
4. Library Access Facilities
5. Meeting/Conference room with projection equipment
6. Laboratory facilities (Based on the need, institute laboratory facilities may be used, subject to approval by the Principal of the college on a case-to-case basis).

5. Promoting Faculty and Student-Led Innovation and Entrepreneurship

For Faculty:

1. Faculty members are encouraged to establish startups based on technologies, innovations, or intellectual property developed by them.
2. Faculty startups may be formed individually or in collaboration with students, alumni, faculty from other institutions, or entrepreneurs.
3. The institute may provide incubation support, workspace, mentoring, infrastructure, legal assistance, IPR support, and seed funding, subject to availability.
4. In return for institutional support, the institute may hold an equity stake in the startup as per prevailing institutional and regulatory norms.
5. Faculty members may serve as founders, directors, advisors, or executives in startups with prior approval from the institute.
6. Faculty involvement in startup activities should not exceed the permissible limits prescribed by the institute and should not affect academic or administrative responsibilities.
7. Research activities of the institute and startup operations must be clearly separated to avoid conflicts of interest.
8. Institute employees, research scholars, and staff shall not be involved in startup activities without proper approval and compliance with institutional policies.
9. Faculty assuming full-time managerial responsibilities in a startup may be required to avail sabbatical leave, leave without pay, or other approved leave provisions.

10. Startups promoted by faculty are encouraged to incubate within the institute's incubation ecosystem and comply with the institute's IPR and incubation policies.

For Students:

1. Students are encouraged to participate in innovation, entrepreneurship, and startup activities through interdisciplinary and inter-institutional collaborations.
2. Students may establish startups, work on startup projects, or undertake internships in incubated startups while pursuing their academic programs.
3. Academic credits may be awarded for startup-related activities, prototype development, innovation projects, business model development, and entrepreneurial achievements as per institutional regulations.
4. Startup ideas, prototypes, and entrepreneurial ventures may be considered for mini-projects, major projects, internships, seminars, or experiential learning requirements with appropriate approvals.
5. Student entrepreneurs may receive incubation support, mentoring, access to institutional facilities, participation in hackathons, innovation challenges, boot camps, and may be considered for academic flexibility, including semester breaks and attendance relaxations, as per institute regulations and review committee recommendations.

6. Financial Support

SRKREC is committed to promoting innovation, entrepreneurship, and startup development by providing financial assistance to promising student, faculty, alumni, and community-led ventures. The institute may provide financial support of up to Two Lakhs rupees for product development and up to Five Lakhs rupees for commercialization activities for eligible incubated startups, subject to the recommendations of the Innovation and Incubation Committee. Faculty innovators may receive seed funding up to Five Lakhs rupees to support the journey from ideation and prototype development to venture creation. Financial support to alumni and community innovators shall be considered on a case-by-case basis through a mutually agreed incubation and funding agreement.

To encourage participation in innovation challenges and startup competitions, the institute may provide travel support, registration fee reimbursement, and other eligible expenses for students and faculty participating in national-level hackathons, innovation contests, startup expos, and entrepreneurship events, subject to institute norms and budget availability.

The Seed Fund process shall generally follow the stages listed below:

- (i) Submission of Seed Fund application by the incubatee.
- (ii) Preliminary screening and initial interaction.

- (iii) Review, feedback, and guidance by the Internal Evaluation Team.
- (iv) Presentation before the Evaluation Committee.
- (v) Approval and confirmation of Seed Funding.
- (vi) Completion of necessary documentation and agreements.
- (vii) Release of phase-I funding.
- (viii) Periodic technical and financial review of progress.

All incubated startups receiving financial support from the institute shall maintain proper financial records and utilize funds exclusively for approved startup activities.

The incubatee shall submit a yearly audited statement of accounts, utilization certificates, progress reports, and other documents as prescribed by the institute. Continuation of incubation support and release of subsequent funding instalments shall be subject to satisfactory technical, financial, and operational performance reviews conducted by the institute or its authorized committee.

In consideration of the incubation, infrastructure, mentoring, and other support services provided by the Institute, it may acquire an equity stake ranging from 2% to 10% in the startup (As per the policy guidelines of the state government and AICTE National Innovation and Startup Policy (NISP)).

7. Conflicts of interest

In case of any conflict of interest arising between the incubatee, startup, faculty member, student, or the Institute, the decision of the Institute shall be final and binding on all concerned parties.

8. Agreements

All incubatees shall enter into the following agreements with the Institute, as applicable:

Incubation agreement: This agreement shall outline the terms and conditions of incubation, including infrastructure support, mentoring, facilities, incubation duration, equity participation (if applicable), obligations of the incubatee, and other relevant incubation norms. *(Applicable to all incubatees.)*

Seed fund agreement: This agreement shall govern the terms and conditions for sanction, utilization, monitoring, reporting, and disbursement of seed funding provided by the Institute. *(Applicable to incubatees receiving seed funding.)*

Technology commercialization agreement: This agreement shall be applicable to incubatees utilizing technologies, intellectual property, patents, know-how, or research outcomes developed within the Institute. The agreement shall specify the rights, responsibilities, licensing terms,

revenue sharing mechanisms, and commercialization conditions. (*Applicable to incubatees using Institute-owned or co-owned intellectual property.*)

Non-Disclosure and confidentiality agreement (NDA): Where required, incubatees shall execute a confidentiality agreement to protect proprietary information, trade secrets, intellectual property, and other confidential business or research information shared during the incubation process.

Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Agreement: This agreement shall define ownership, protection, licensing, commercialization, and revenue-sharing arrangements related to intellectual property generated during the incubation period, in accordance with the Institute's IPR Policy.

Glossary (Source: National innovation and startup policy 2019 for students and faculty)

Term	Definition
Accelerators	Startup accelerators design programs in batches and transform promising business ideas into reality under the guidance of mentors and other available resources.
Angel Fund	An angel investor is a wealthy individual who invests personal capital, shares expertise, contacts, and mentorship in exchange for equity in a startup.
Cash Flow Management	The process of tracking how much money is coming into and going out of a business.
Co-Creation	The act of creating together by developing business models, products, or services with customers, partners, or stakeholders.
Compulsory Equity	A form of ownership in which shareholders undertake entrepreneurial risk and possess voting rights in the company.
Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)	A self-regulating business model that helps a company be socially accountable to itself, stakeholders, and the public.
Cross-Disciplinary	Teaching, learning, and research activities that cut across disciplinary boundaries.
Entrepreneurial Culture	A culture that promotes values, beliefs, attitudes, and behaviours associated with entrepreneurship.
Entrepreneurial Individuals	Individuals with an entrepreneurial mindset who seek to transform ideas into successful ventures.
Entrepreneurship Education	Educational activities that provide knowledge, skills, and motivation for entrepreneurial success.
Experiential Learning	Learning through direct experience and reflection on practical activities.
Financial Management	The application of management principles to the financial resources of an enterprise.
Hackathon	A collaborative event where programmers, designers, project managers, and experts work intensively on innovative projects.
Host Institution	Technology, management, or R&D institutions that support startups and foster entrepreneurial ecosystems.
Incubation	A structured process providing infrastructure, resources, and support to nurture startups during early development stages.
Intellectual Property Rights Licensing	A partnership where the owner of intellectual property authorizes another party to use those rights in exchange for fees or royalties.
Knowledge Exchange	A process that brings together researchers, practitioners, and communities to exchange ideas, evidence, and expertise.
Pedagogy and Experiential Learning	Teaching methods focused on practical learning, business cases, field interactions, and startup-oriented education.
Pre-Incubation	Early-stage support for entrepreneurs with ideas or prototypes before entering full incubation programs.
Prototype	An early sample or model of a product developed to test a concept or process.

Science Parks	Purpose-built clusters of offices, laboratories, and innovation spaces that support research and technology development.
Seed Fund	Early-stage investment capital provided to startups in exchange for equity ownership.
Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV)	A subsidiary entity created to isolate financial risk from its parent organization.
Startup	An entity built around product or service innovation with the potential to be scalable, replicable, and self-reliant.
Technology Business Incubator (TBI)	An organization that provides resources, infrastructure, and support to technology-based startups.
Technology Commercialization	The process of converting research outcomes and technologies into marketable products or services.
Technology Licensing	An agreement allowing another party to use, modify, or commercialize technology in exchange for compensation.
Technology Management	The planning, design, operation, optimization, and control of technological products, processes, and services.
Venture Capital	A form of startup financing in which investors provide capital and strategic support in exchange for equity.